Lesson 15 Teacher's Key: Ready to Show

GameMaker - Instructor Reference Only

VIDEO GAME CREATION

How This Key Is Different Today

There's no new Level 1 solution to give this week - Lesson 15 is a polish-and-present day, not a new-mechanic day. This Key instead consolidates the most common last-mile issues seen across this engine's Lessons 2-14, to help you diagnose a stuck student quickly during polish time.

Known Recurring Quirks in This Engine

- A missing obj_spawner. prefix somewhere in code that runs from obj_bullet or obj_enemy, causing a variable-scope error or a silently-wrong instance being modified.
- An Alarm set (alarm[0] = N) with no matching Alarm event added, so nothing ever happens when it expires.
- A Sound resource created but never assigned an actual imported file, so audio_play_sound() runs with no audible result and no error.

Fast Diagnostic Questions

- "Run the game (F5) and check for a red error dialog" - GameMaker surfaces scope/reference errors directly.
- "Does this object actually have the Alarm/Step/Collision event you think it does?" - easy to add code to the wrong event by habit.

If a Student Is Significantly Behind

Prioritize getting Lessons 6-11's Level 1 (win/lose, restart, multiple waves) solidly working before anything from Lessons 12-14 - a complete, simple game presents better than a broken ambitious one.

Presentation Day Notes

- Have students run from the correct starting Room before presenting, in case testing left a different Room set as default.